the topmost "citadel" still awaits exploration in upcoming seasons. In the 2014–2015 tours, Lorain and his team also encompassed the site of Chehel Dukhtaran to the south of Shahr-i Ghulghula. Cf. Lorain 2018; also Ball 2019: No. 1042.

73. See esp. Gardin 1957; cf. also Gascoigne 2010 for discussion of parallels and divergences between ceramic finds at Shahr-i Ghulghula and Jam-Firuzkuh. Now that the ceramic collections of the Herat Museum have undergone analysis, further parallels will surely emerge and better contextualize the Bamiyan–Ghulghula assemblages: cf. Franke 2016b, 2016c; Müller-Wiener 2016; Franke and Müller-Wiener 2016. Ultimately, *all* of these considerations must be framed against the glaring need to revisit the entirety of Gardin's collected ceramic corpus and his conclusions, not least given the fact that the materials were largely gathered through purchases at local markets rather than from documented archaeological contexts; and the sheer quantity of remains that would have probably exceeded the very short period of production proposed by Gardin (T. Lorain, pers. comm., September 2018).
74. Cf. Godard 1951: 5, figs. 1 and 4; Ball 2019: No. 1042.
75. See Baker and Allchin 1991: 28–30; Rugiadi 2006; Ball 2008: 166, 171; Thomas 2018: 217, 220. Lorain (pers. comm., September 2018) noted that the wooden doors' whereabouts now are unknown. While Warwick Ball (pers. comm., April 2018) confirmed Shahr-i Ghulghula's pre-Islamic construction – citing a Buddhist *stupa* and a hoard of T'ang Chinese bronzes recently documented there – he also noted a fundamental difference between Zuhak and Ghulghula: while Ghulghula was "the more urban site for Bamiyan (albeit fortified) … in use down to the Mongol conquest, [Zuhak was] solely a fortification." Ghulghula's high-quality ceramics, the intricately carved wooden doors, and the recent documentation of probably Ghaznavid-period palatial remains (cf. below in main text) would suggest multiple functions for the complex, including a royal residence/palace. Cf. Godard 1951; Gardin 1957; Baker and Allchin 1991: 28–30.
76. Cf. also Godard 1951.
77. R. Giunta, pers. comm., July 2018; Giunta 2020; cf. also Chapter 5.
78. Lorain 2018.
79. Cf. Bosworth 1988; Baker and Allchin 1991: esp. 163; and see Chapter 4. See also O'Neal (2020: 205–207) for numismatic evidence elucidating the nature of the Shansabanis' periodic occupations of Balkh as they confronted their various adversaries, including the Khwarazm-shahs in the 1190s CE.
80. Danestama is comparable with another, somewhat mysterious and probably multi-purpose structure northeast of Multan (Pakistan), just east of the Indus River's current flow. It was newly constructed in the third or fourth quarter of the twelfth century, though documentation by the present author in 1998 took note of older fragments used as building material in the walls; moreover, the Indus structure's plan very much echoes Danestama (Figures 6.16 and 6.17). Cf. Dani 1982: 183; Mumtaz 1985: 39–42; Edwards 1991; and Chapter 5.
81. See esp. Inaba (2013), and the discussion of the many Ghaznavid palaces (e.g., Balkh, Ghazna, Bust-Lashkari Bazar, Nishapur), palace–garden complexes (e.g., also Nishapur, Herat, Bust), as well as royal tent complexes used by the